

consumer electronics (LCD TV sets and mobile phones) and lighting (CFL and LED) are some of the products for which SMT machines are widely used. Also, today, defence electronics products need high-end machines for assembly.

Telecom and automotive, the most prominent industries in India, will continue to contribute significantly to India's GDP in the coming years. The mobile revolution and adoption of technologies such as WiMax and VoIP are necessitating indigenous manufacturing of various telecom products such as handsets, base stations, modems and VOIP phones, thus creating the demand for SMT equipment.

Automobiles are using an increasing percentage of electronic components and control units. And local manufacturing of automotive electronic products is further driving the demand for SMT equipment to improve production efficiency.

“Faster, more accurate and higher-density assembly with a great flexibility is what the market demands—N. Chandramohan, country head (SMT Division), Juki India



Complete SMT production lines from ESSEMTEC AG, Switzerland

Technological trends

SMT equipment suppliers need to provide the most advanced equipment at competitive prices. They need to upgrade their products in sync with the evolution of the electronics manufacturing processes. Increasing use of miniature printed circuit boards

(PCBs) in various application segments is forcing them to develop and offer cost-effective and high-technology solutions to their OEM and EMS customers.

“SMT equipment vendors need to strike the right balance between technology and price in order to gain a competitive edge,” explains Bharath. “The best strategy in pricing lies in being cost-effective while ensuring provision of value-added services for customers.”

“Faster, more accurate and higher-density assembly with a great flexibility is what the market demands,”



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